

The Boston Globe

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TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 29, 2026

Region dodged flooding, this time

Experts say luck, preparation key

By Kate Selig and Ken Mahan
GLOBE STAFF

Why didn't Massachusetts get utterly swamped by this weekend's nor'easter?

The slow-moving storm brought near-hurricane-force winds and dumped more than two months' worth of rain on parts of Southern New England.

But major, widespread flooding — the kind that inundates buildings and basements and renders roads impassable — never materialized.

Weather experts say a large part of the reason comes down to luck with the atmospheric conditions. The rain remained light to moderate for the most part; there was no continuous onslaught of downpours. Even with multiday rain totals pushing 10 inches for some communities, the ground was able to absorb rainwater quickly enough to avoid extensive, severe flooding.

"Every time a nor'easter comes, we roll the dice," said Nasser Brahim, the climate resilience director for the Mystic River Watershed Association.

He said that if the storm had struck early this week, the astronomical tides, controlled by the gravitational pull from the moon and sun, would have been about a foot higher than they were over the weekend — increasing the

RAIN, Page A10

►Region takes account of minimal storm damage. B1.



A three-wring circus

Tuesday: Rain ends early. High 65-70, low 56-61.

Wednesday: Peeks of sun. High 66-71, low 58-63.

High tide: 1:20, 1:34.

Sunrise: 6:39. Sunset: 6:29.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9-10.**

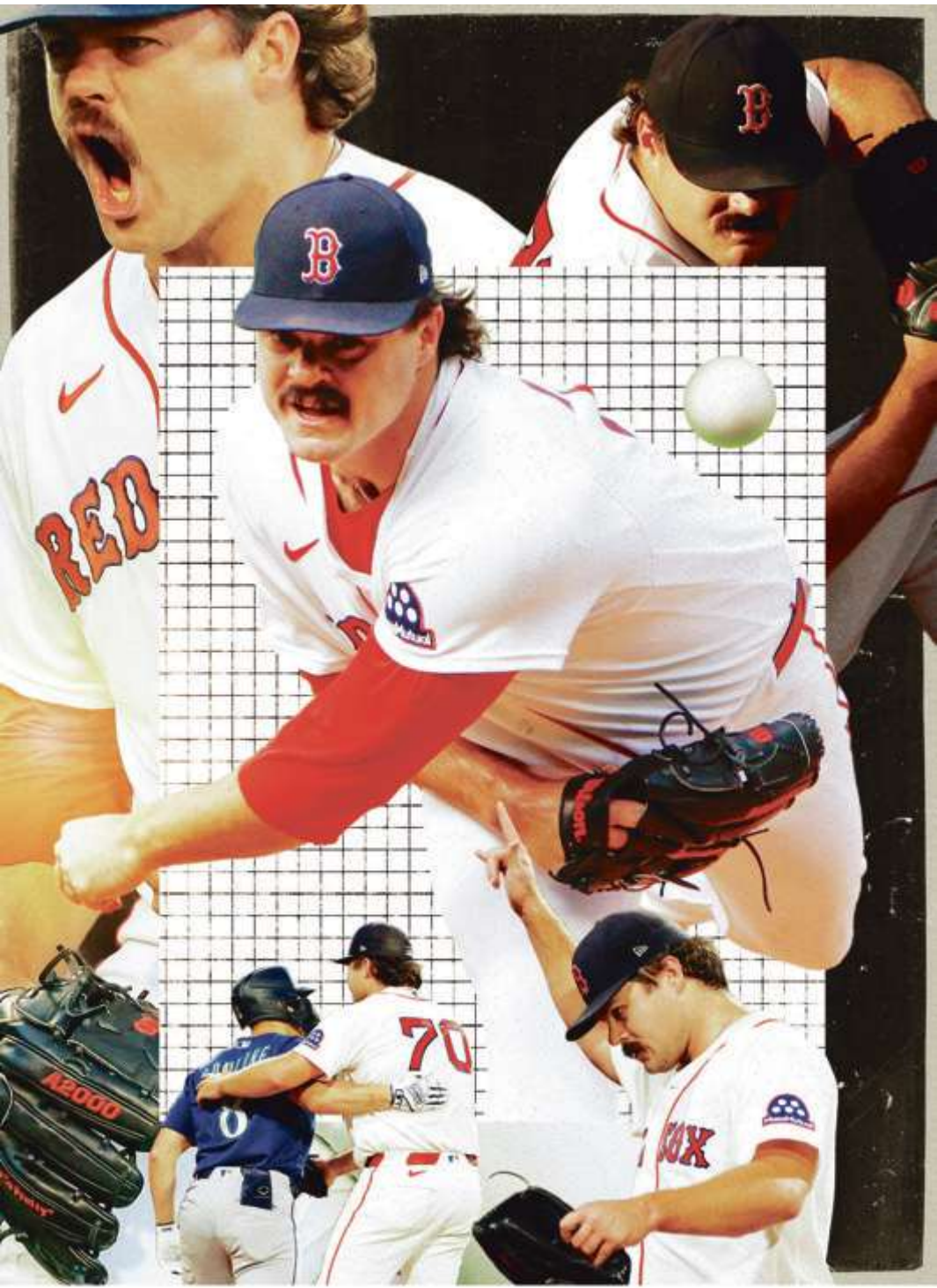
The city of Boston is suing the Trump administration for withholding a grant that would have funded street safety and transit upgrades in Roxbury. **B1.**

A prosecutor planned to re-open an investigation into accusations of rape at a Cornell fraternity. **A2.**

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A MOUND MAESTRO, WITH A MADCAP TWIST

Tolle's stint with Sox is already storied. Next chapter? The Yanks.

By Peter Abraham
GLOBE STAFF

One thing you learn when working on a Payton Tolle story: Everybody has a Payton Tolle story.

"I've got one," Red Sox manager Chad Tracy said last week.

Tolle pitched his first game for Triple-A Worcester on Aug. 10 last season, a significant career milestone at the time.

With one out and a runner on first base in the first inning, Tolle got a ground ball to second. It should have been an inning-ending double play, but the ball was booted. Tolle walked the next hitter on five pitches to

load the bases.

Tolle was determined to throw a strike to the next hitter, and he did. It was launched 414 feet to left field for a grand slam. Then came a single and another home run.

Tracy, who was Worcester's manager at the time, sent pitching coach Dan DeLucia to the mound to give the big lefthander a pep talk. But Tolle was smiling when he got there.

"Well, that didn't go how I was hoping it would go," Tolle cracked.

Tolle made his major league debut 19 days later. By the end of the season, he was on the playoff roster as a

TOLLE, Page C5

PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY LUIS G. RENDON/GLOBE STAFF;
PHOTOS: DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN AND MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Lobsters, live — and livestreamed to your shopping cart

By Hiawatha Bray
GLOBE STAFF

SOUTH FREEPORT, Maine — Casco Bay in September has everything Mark Murrell could wish for: brilliant sun, calm waves, and excellent 5G wireless service.

It's showtime for Murrell, who is about to give literal meaning to the old saying, *buying seafood right off the boat* — but in 21st-century form.

As his friend's lobster boat

shoves off from the docks to haul traps, Murrell peers at the smartphone camera held by crew member Marc Beaudry and begins a stream of cheerful chatter aimed at moving merchandise, and fast, to customers all around the country.

"We're just shipping off right now, and we'll have an epic time," said the bareheaded lobsterman, dressed in a sweat shirt and bib overalls of orange rubber and wielding a squirm-

ing lobster in his hands.

What follows over the next 90 minutes is part nature documentary, part used-car auction. As customers bid for five-pound boxes of fresh-caught lobster — starting price, \$95 — Murrell and his lobsterman colleague Jack Thomas deliver a series of mini-lectures on lobster lore.

Did you know there are left- and right-handed lobsters?

LIVESTREAM, Page A10



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

This lobster may be part of an emerging trend in US commerce: Merchants selling products via video streams.



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